

How to Get Ahead of 99% of Men

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 07, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ons1rhBHPMQ> Source: Full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter breaks down his "Victory Cyclone" framework — a repeating cycle of challenge, reflection, decision, and testing — arguing that small, consistent choices compounded over time create an enormous gap between those who win and those who stagnate.

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Who Brandon Carter Is and Why He Can Teach This 0:41

- Over the past **15 years**, Carter has helped **more than 15,000 people** build successful online fitness businesses
 - Thousands of his students now earn **over \$100,000 per year**
 - Some members of his community earn **over \$1 million per year**
- He has also helped thousands reach their best-ever physical fitness — fat loss and muscle building in record time
- He credits his own success to the "Victory Cyclone" framework taught in this video
 - Built **multiple seven-figure businesses** and **one eight-figure business**
 - Maintains strong physical fitness, healthy family relationships, and lives what he describes as his dream life
- Emphasizes he is not someone who "can't do the work" teaching others — he has lived these principles himself



The Gap: Why Two People Starting Equal End Up Worlds Apart [1:23](#)

- At any given moment, some people are advancing while others are stagnant or sliding backward
- Key insight: **if you are not improving, you are falling behind** — because the world is constantly improving
 - Example: five years ago, no one had ChatGPT; now everyone has a "super agent" on their phone
 - Competitors get better; the baseline rises whether you participate or not
- Life naturally grows harder as you age — childhood has no responsibility, but each stage adds new complexity
 - High school: hormones, relationships, academic pressure, social navigation
 - After high school: college or career — an even steeper jump in difficulty
 - Career, marriage, children, health decline — challenges stack continuously
- The gap between people is built by **years of small daily decisions**, compounded
 - Carter's personal example: when he started his online fitness business, other trainers around him were fitter, more attractive, and had more advantages — but they didn't try
 - Today, the gap between him and those same people is enormous
- "Everything adds up. A decision made repeatedly over time just compounds."
 - Posting once on social media won't grow your following; consistent posting will
 - Eating one salad won't make you fit; sustained daily choices will



The Victory Cyclone: The Core Framework [5:12](#)

- A repeating four-stage cycle that governs all growth and success
- The cycle never stops — even in retirement you face new challenges (e.g., fighting mortality)
- Each time you complete the cycle successfully, you grow; each time you quit, you fall behind and the gap widens

Stage	Label	Core Question
1	Challenge	What problem or opportunity can I no longer ignore?
2	Think & Plan	What are my options and what is the best path?
3	Decide & Commit	Will I actually take this path — yes or no?
4	Tests	Can I hold the line when difficulty arrives?



Stage 1 — The Challenge (Recognizing the Problem) [5:12](#)

- A challenge is any problem or opportunity that forces you to acknowledge a need to change
 - Can be dramatic: Carter's father died by suicide (self-inflicted gunshot wound) — Carter's biggest personal challenge

- Can be subtle: noticing a gap between where you are and where you want to be, or realizing you dislike the direction your life is heading
- Carter's backstory as context:
 - Before his father's death, he was a personal trainer but also involved in illegal/dangerous activities he won't specify
 - His friend **SV** is serving life in prison for double homicide — never getting out
 - His friend **Esko** was found shot dead in New Jersey, his car riddled with bullets
 - Seeing those around him die or go to prison for life made Carter realize: "If you become like the people around you and they're dying or going to jail forever, maybe I should change direction"
 - His father's suicide — who was his best friend — was the final catalyst: "Okay, it's time to change"
- Challenges appear in every life domain:
 - **Fitness**: repeatedly promising yourself you'll take care of your body but not following through
 - **Business**: seeing an opportunity but being too afraid to act — "acting like a coward"
 - **Circumstance**: being forced into a decision because life leaves no alternative

Stage 2 — Think and Plan (Considering Options) 7:59

- Once you recognize the challenge, you must consider your available options and form a plan
- Think through what is logical, what paths exist, and which one moves you toward your goal
- Carter's 2008/2009 planning example:
 - His father died just as the **2008 financial crisis** hit — Lehman Brothers collapsed, stock market crashed, **unemployment hit 10%**
 - Nobody was hiring; the only income path he knew was the dangerous one that had already killed or imprisoned his friends
 - He eliminated that option entirely: "I know where that road ends"
 - His plan: take every legitimate job he could find simultaneously
 - Woke up at **4:00 AM**, trained clients in the mornings near **145th Street in Harlem**
 - Took the F train to SoHo, worked **8 hours as a doorman** at a product store
 - Evenings: worked at a friend's **moving company in New York**, 5 days a week
 - Weekends: managed a **BBQ restaurant on Steinway Street in Astoria, Queens**
 - Result: **7 days a week, 12–14 hours a day** for 2 straight years
- **Critical warning on the thinking stage**: many people get permanently stuck here
 - "I'll start Monday." "Let me watch one more video." "I'm still preparing."
 - Research shows that **setting a specific start date** dramatically increases the likelihood you actually begin
 - Gather enough information to understand the problem — but do not live in analysis indefinitely

Stage 3 — Decide and Commit (Choosing a Path) 10:25

- This is where intention becomes action — you must actually choose a direction and start moving
- Three possible outcomes at this stage:
 - **Move forward** — commit and begin
 - **Delay further** — procrastinate indefinitely (effectively the same as not doing it)
 - **Quit** — consciously decline and return to old habits
- Only one of these moves you forward and only one makes you proud of yourself
- The hidden cost of cowardice: "Nobody knows you chose the coward path — but **you** know. And it erodes your confidence from the inside."
- On confidence: people ask Carter how to become more confident
 - His answer: they aren't confident because they haven't **created reasons to be confident**
 - They avoid challenges, avoid their fears, let fear control them
 - "You have to build the evidence of your own success. Start creating proof."
- Carter's forced commitment: in 2008 with no jobs available and dangerous paths eliminated, he had no real choice — he just took every job he could get
 - Notes that having too many options actually makes commitment harder for most people — they start something, stop, pivot, try 18 things at once — "the fastest way to fail"

Stage 4 — The Tests (What Tries to Knock You Off Course) 12:52

- Once you are on the path, tests arrive — they reveal who you really are under pressure
- Tests come in many forms:
 - **Willpower tests**: Can you give up short-term pleasure for long-term gain? Can you delay gratification?
 - **Thinking tests**: Can you think long-term instead of short-term?
 - **Physical tests** (especially fitness goals): cravings, slow visible progress, being surrounded by people eating junk food — temptation is constant
 - **Business tests**: a launch fails, income comes slower than expected, results lag
 - **Social tests**: peers telling you that you're doing too much — "Relax, bro."
 - **Emotional/life tests**: bad days, relationship friction, children in trouble, car accidents, illness of loved ones, stock market crashes, natural disasters, death of someone close
- "In the 90 days between setting a goal and achieving it, all kinds of things will happen. Whether you reach it depends largely on how you handle those disruptions."
- Carter's example after his father's death: people told him to take time to grieve
 - His response: "Sitting around doesn't pay the bills."
 - He worked 12–14 hours a day for 2 years: "I didn't break down. I took care of myself and my family."
- Core principle: **your emotions must not control your behavior** — you can feel terrible and still stay the course

The test is not just pass/fail — it also asks: Are you flexible enough to adapt your plan without abandoning your goal entirely?

⚠️ The Mediocrity Mantras: The Most Dangerous Trap [13:54](#)

- Carter identifies "mediocrity mantras" as the single most dangerous thing to success
- Definition: the things people (often well-meaning friends) say that give you permission to slip
 - "Bro, you can take a day off."
 - "You've been working so hard, you deserve a rest."
 - "You can eat that — you don't need to stick to your diet."
 - "One bite won't kill you."
 - "One day off is no big deal."
- Why they're called mediocrity mantras: "By definition, average people are mediocre. And this is what average people do."
- What actually happens when you accept them:
 - You allow inconsistency into your routine
 - You rationalize bad decisions
 - You become inconsistent — and **inconsistency is why you struggle to stay consistent**
 - The real damage: "You can fool everyone else. You can tell all the lies. But you can't fool yourself. You know deep down you're not living up to your potential."
 - That self-awareness quietly **destroys your confidence** from within
- "Mediocrity mantras are the battle cry of the inconsistent man."
- Key distinction: one bite or one rest day won't literally harm you — but it **won't help you either**, and it breaks the identity you are building

🔄 The Cycle Never Ends — And That's the Point [17:02](#)

- After passing one test, another challenge arrives — the cycle repeats for life
- Carter's own cycle continued after surviving the 2-year grind:
 - Realized working 4 jobs forever was unsustainable
 - New idea arrived in **2009**: move the fitness business online
 - At the time this was a "crazy idea" — he was among the **first people ever to offer online fitness training**
 - New tests: no guides, no predecessors, no one to teach him — he had to figure everything out himself
 - Payoff: because he navigated it first, his students today reach the same goals **far faster** than he did
- Life stages stack these cycles continuously:
 - High school → college/career → marriage → children → health challenges → aging
 - Each stage is harder than the last; the cycle simply restarts at a higher difficulty

- Two types of people facing the same challenge after 5 years:

Person A	Person B
Constantly training, learning, adapting	Waiting to feel ready, seeking perfection before starting
Fails sometimes but always gets back up	Never starts, so never fails — but also never grows
Continuously compounding upward	Stuck at square one or sliding backward

- "Being ready is not a feeling, idiot." — Carter on waiting until you feel prepared
- The upward trajectory is built from accumulated good days:
 - One perfect day is meaningless on its own
 - Stack perfect days → perfect weeks → perfect months → **momentum builds**
- There is no true stagnation: if you are not improving, you are falling behind because the world advances regardless
- Carter on his own 15-year track record: "From the outside it looks like continuous, uninterrupted success. But there were massive failures — some very dramatic. You just never stop. You never take your eyes off the goal. You keep going."

Your Immediate Next Steps 20:10

- Carter gives the viewer a concrete action sequence to apply the Victory Cyclone immediately:
 - **Step 1:** Identify what challenges are currently in front of you — what needs to change in your life right now?
 - **Step 2:** Think through your options — what paths are realistically available to you?
 - **Step 3:** Make a decision today — which path will you commit to, and when does it start? (Set a specific date)
 - **Step 4:** Anticipate the tests — think ahead about what obstacles will likely arise and how you will respond, because something *will* come up
- "Nobody reaches their goals without going through challenges. Not even in Hollywood movies. Everyone faces the mountain."
- Final framing: the choice is always between moving forward, delaying, or quitting — only one of them leads anywhere worth going
- Carter also promotes a **free live training** on growing an online fitness business using AI:
 - Topics covered: writing content with AI, growing followers, getting clients, training clients with AI for better results
 - Open to beginners and veterans alike; no certification required
 - Includes free AI tools for content ideation, scripting, and editing
 - Register via the link in the video description; live Q&A before, during, and after